

Adobe XD

Convert your digital vision into an interactive reality

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"Digital is the new default." This statement from the product page of Adobe XD is enough

to describe the importance of this UI and UX design offering from Adobe. A go-to tool for industry professionals, Adobe XD, since its launch, has built a name for itself, cementing its position in the workflow of designers and developers of all experience levels. The software allows users to create websites, games, applications and brand designs using tools that are relatively intuitive and easy to use. Being a part of the family of the already renowned Adobe line of creative tools, XD with its capability of being a useful tool for professionals and starters alike, can be used in a variety of workflows, some of which were mentioned above.

GET ART ON THE BOARD

When developing an application in Adobe XD, the term that is used to define the various spaces and pages present in your application or webpage is artboard. To put it in simpler words, the artboard is your canvas in Adobe XD. All the designing and development that takes place is represented on the artboard, and that is the place where you work when designing.

When you open Adobe XD, the welcome screen has a set of preset artboard sizes that you can choose from. The first of the three predetermined ones is that for phones under which you have options for different phone types. Next is for a webpage, which is set to 1920 by 1080 pixels. And the last is for social media posts and uploads, under which there are multiple types listed,



with each one having its own specific size. If you want to create your initial artboard of a custom size, then click on the rightmost option in the group, labelled as Custom Size. Enter the dimensions of your artboard or choose from the ones listed, and you will be taken to the workspace.

Each artboard has a name, which you can set according to your preference. The name of the artboard is shown in the top left corner, which can be changed by double-clicking and keying in the new name. If you want to add more artboards to your project, mouse over to the icon on the left action pane of the app and click on it. This is the artboard tool and allows you to create artboards of your choice. You can also customise the prop-

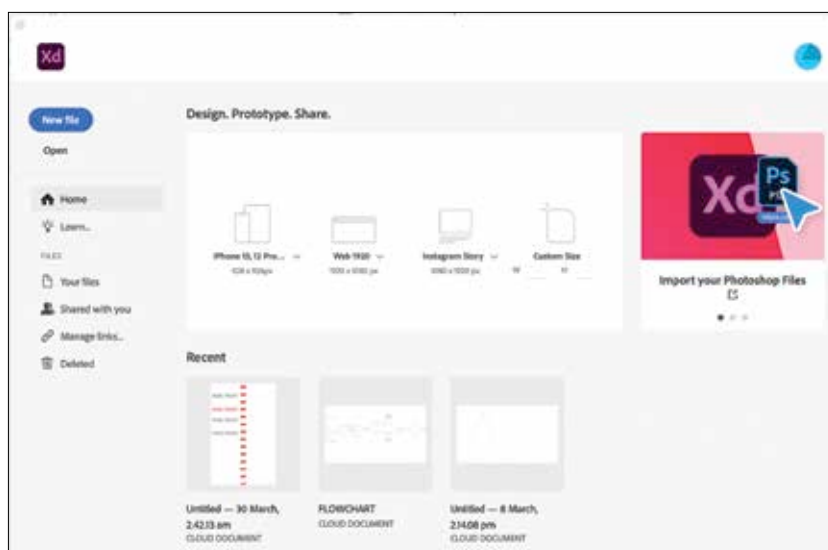
erties of each artboard by selecting it and then going to the customisation pane along the right side of the window. Here, to make aligning your elements easier, there is a grid layout option, which you can enable by checking the layout box present in the bottom part of the menu. These can further be customised using the options that appear.

CHOOSING THE RIGHT MODE

In Adobe XD, there are three basic modes for you to choose from when working on a project. They are the Design mode, Prototype mode, and the Share mode. Depending upon the stage your project is in or what you want to do in the software, you can choose between these modes.

The Design mode, as the name suggests, lets you make changes to the different components and parts of your project to make it user friendly, in line with the expectations of your clients or the person you are working for. It also allows you to make it aesthetically pleasing. In the Prototype mode, you define the functionality of the app by creating flows and changing animation and transition styles. If you want to share the project for review, commentary or collaboration, the Share mode is the one to choose.

The default mode that a fresh project opens in is the Design mode. You can switch between different modes by clicking on the buttons represented by the names of these modes in the top bar of the application window.



This is the screen you will be greeted with when you open XD